

Valentin Marchal

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🌐 Personal Website

EMPLOYMENT

University of Konstanz

Postdoctoral researcher at the Cluster of Excellence "The Politics of Inequality"

2026–

Konstanz

EDUCATION

Sciences Po

PhD in Economics

2020–2026

Paris

- Thesis title: "Essays on Rational Bubbles"
- Supervisor: Stéphane Guibaud
- Thesis Committee: Nicolas Coeurdacier and Jeanne Commault

Pompeu Fabra University

Visiting PhD Student

Spring 2024

Barcelona

- Sponsors: Alberto Martin and Jaume Ventura

Sciences Po

Master in Economics - Summa Cum Laude

2018–2020

Paris

- Master's thesis: "Safety Traps in an Open Economy" under the supervision of Nicolas Coeurdacier

Sciences Po and Université de Lorraine

Double degree: BA in Social Sciences (Cum Laude) and Economics (Mention Bien)

2015–2018

Nancy

- Exchange year at the University of Mannheim

WORK IN PROGRESS

A Scrooge McDuck Theory of Wealth Dynamics

Peter Sinclair Prize (Joint First Place), awarded by the Money, Macro and Finance Society

Can the rise in the wealth-to-output ratio observed in advanced economies over recent decades be explained by an increase in top income inequality? Recent contributions that advance this interpretation struggle to account for the fact that the increase in wealth was driven by asset prices, rather than capital accumulation. This paper shows that these stylized facts can be reconciled in the presence of *insatiable* preference for wealth. Such preferences induce a cap on optimal consumption—which is more likely to become binding when income inequality is large. When it does, top-income agents accumulate diverging wealth over time while keeping their consumption bounded. This consumption-saving behavior then supports the existence of a uniquely determined rational bubble, which grows at a rate that *exceeds* that of the economy. The bubble crowds out investment, while its diverging price sustains a permanent rise in wealth inequality. In this environment, wealth and capital income taxes are not equivalent, but both can shift the equilibrium from bubbly to non-bubbly—thus being potentially redistributive and growth-*enhancing*. A quantitative exercise suggests that a 1.5 percent wealth tax in the U.S. would raise capital by 4.5 percent over 30 years.

Rational Bubbles in the Ecological Transition

Public Debt in Times of Rising Wealth-to-Output Ratio

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026: BSE Summer Forum, BSE; ADRES Job Market Conference, CES Sorbonne University; Toulouse School of Economics

2025: EEA Congress, University of Bordeaux; PhD Seminar, CREST; Finance PhD Workshop (Discussant), Paris Dauphine University; Doctoral Workshop on Quantitative Dynamic Economics, University of Konstanz; MMF PhD Conference, Loughborough University; Internal Seminar, Mannheim University; AFSE Annual Congress, ENS Paris-Saclay; Doctorissimes Conference, PSE; MMF Annual Conference, University of Reading; Friday Seminar, Sciences Po

2024: PhD Jamboree, BSE; International Lunch Seminar, CREI; Doctoral Conference, Ruhr Graduate School in Economics; Friday Seminar, Sciences Po

REFEREEING ACTIVITY

Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control

TEACHING

International Finance and Trade	2020–2025
<i>Sciences Po, Undergraduate course</i>	<i>Reims</i>

- Instructor of two to three classes each year
- Lecturer: Nicolas Coeurdacier and Thierry Mayer

Financial Markets	Spring 2025
<i>Sciences Po, Master course</i>	<i>Paris</i>

- Teaching Assistant to Stéphane Guibaud

Macro-history	Fall 2023
<i>Sciences Po, Master course</i>	<i>Paris</i>

- Teaching Assistant to Paul Bouscasse and Moritz Schularick

Producer Theory	Spring 2020
<i>Université Paris Descartes, Undergrade course</i>	<i>Malakoff</i>

- Instructor of two classes
- Lecturer: Marie-Hélène Jeanneret-Crettez

Economic Information Analysis	Fall 2019
<i>Université Paris Descartes, Undergrade course</i>	<i>Malakoff</i>

- Instructor of two classes
- Lecturer: Sébastien Cochard

SKILLS

Computational: Julia, R

Languages: French (Native), English (Fluent), German (Fluent), Spanish (Beginner)

REFERENCES

Stéphane Guibaud

Professor of Economics
Sciences Po
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Nicolas Coeurdacier

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